

The need for testing

HIV test is required for confirmation of an underlying HIV infection. HIV counseling & testing services are available at 72 Integrated Counseling & Testing Centres (ICTCs) in all major Govt. hospitals and some dispensaries of Delhi. The HIV testing is confidential and the result is available within 30 minutes.

Individuals with one or more of the following risk factors should avail benefit of HIV testing:

- All Pregnant women
- All persons attending Sexually Transmitted Diseases Clinics (with H/O ulcer / sore on genitals, urethral discharge, swelling in groin or testicle)
- Persons with high risk behaviour as regards sexual contact with multiple sex partners, homosexuals, unprotected sex (without use of condoms)
- I.V. Drug Users
- Patients suffering from Tuberculosis
- H/O blood transfusion e.g. repeated transfusions in hemophiliacs & thalassemics.
- Migrant workers
- Truck drivers

Persons who are HIV positive are referred for further management at one of the nine Anti Retroviral Therapy (ART) Centres of Delhi viz; S.J. Hospital, A.I.I.M.S., Lok Nayak Hospital, G.T.B. Hospital, Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital, Kalawati Saran Children Hospital, Deen Dayal Upadhaya Hospital, Guru Teg Bahadur Hospital, and Lala Ram Swaroop Institute of TB & Chest Diseases.

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At ART centre the HIV positive individuals are registered, screened for underlying tuberculosis or other opportunistic infections, and tested for CD4 count. The drugs for treatment of HIV, the anti retroviral (ARV) drugs, are available free of cost. However, initially the opportunistic infections are (ARV) drugs are required only if the CD 4 count falls below 200/cumm & or if the opportunistic infections are life threatening. Individuals with normal CD4 count are kept under follow-up with repeated CD4 count.

